

Understanding Localized Urinary Tract Infections (UTI)



A localized **urinary tract infection (UTI)** occurs when bacteria grow in the bladder or urethra. Common symptoms include:

- Burning or pain when urinating (peeing)
- Urgency to urinate, frequent urination
- Bladder pressure or discomfort
- Blood in the urine (occasionally)



Not all UTIs require antibiotics! If you do not have fevers, chills, or kidney pain, your body may be able to clear this infection without antibiotics. Overuse of antibiotics can lead to antibiotic resistance, recurrent infections, stomach upset, diarrhea, and yeast infection.



Home Care: Let Your Body Heal

Hydrate well: Drink 1.5–2 liters (6–8 cups) of fluid daily to help flush out bacteria. Don't hold your urine.

Pain relief: You may use:

- **Phenazopyridine (AZO, Pyridium)** up to 200 mg every 8 hours for pain or burning. Turns urine bright orange (may stain clothing or contacts).
- **Acetaminophen or ibuprofen** as directed on packaging for pain or fever. Avoid ibuprofen if you are 65+, pregnant, or on blood thinners.

Your symptoms should start improving within a few days.



You've received a Safety Net Antibiotic Prescription (SNAP).

This prescription is provided in case your body is unable to clear the infection on its own. Start antibiotics **if you develop:**

- Fever or chills
- Back or side pain
- Nausea, vomiting, or flu-like symptoms

If you start taking antibiotics, please take the full course.



When to Seek Help

Call your doctor or seek care if:

- Symptoms persist or worsen 3-5 days after taking antibiotics
- Fevers, chills, nausea, or vomiting worsen
- Flank (side/back) pain develops
- You have trouble with your antibiotic medicine



Safe Use of Over-the-Counter Medications

- Read all directions carefully; never exceed recommended doses.
- Avoid medicines you're allergic to or have been told not to take.
- Pregnant? Only use **acetaminophen** unless directed otherwise by your doctor.
- Do **not** give aspirin to anyone under 20 years old.



Preventing Future UTIs

- Drink plenty of fluids each day.
- Urinate regularly and right after sex.
- Change pads or liners frequently.
- Cranberry or D-mannose supplements may help reduce recurrence.



Need Help?

If symptoms persist or worsen, contact **Primary Care** or **Nurse Advice Line** at **(833) 574-2273**.

Learn more at kp.org

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